

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

"Poor wanderers of a stormy day, from wave to wave we're driven;
And fancy's flash and reason's ray serve but to light the troubled
way;--

There's nothing calm but Heaven."

Well to get started at last: I left St. Bonaventure's Monastery, Detroit, August 11th, planning to catch the first train to Chicago, thence to Marathon, Wis. same day, where I'd meet Fr. Maurice and go with him next day to St. Paul where Fr. Edward was expecting us. I was in time for the train o.k. but fortunately failed to catch it. The Dear Lord had planned otherwise: though at the time it did seem to me as the result of nothing less than stupidity on my part. It was only three weeks later, having been to Marathon for the first time, I realized that missing the train that morning saved me twice 65 miles on starting out. Altogether it saved me about 300 miles and, as if all prearranged, enabled me to make happy and unexpected connections which I would hardly have found possible to make otherwise. Thanks be to God!

Instead of to Marathon, I went to Milwaukee, after a very pleasant little repast in Chicago with an old friend, John Gorman and family, who met me at the depot and insisted on us going to a nearby hotel and having dinner. I had not felt particularly hungry at all--in fact I'd not thought of eating --but found that close to 12 hours on a cup of coffee and a small slice of bread had provided quite a vacancy when we sat down to a well spread table. How mindful of my need was the Good God to inspire my friend so charitably! We had a real friendly recreation that night in the first monastery (S. Francis) I had visited 40 years before, on my way to the privileged Noviciate.

After Holy Mass next morning I got in touch by long distance telephone with Fr. Maurice--Joachim rather--and had an understanding with him to join me at New Lisbon (Wis.) on the west-bound Hiawatha. That gave me till 2 P.M. to visit our different houses in Milwaukee and meet all the Brethern, instead of hurrying away on the Omaha at 10 A. M. At about 4 o'clock we made our second stop at said New L. where Fr. M. J. had arrived by bus from Marathon 65 miles to the north. At Milwaukee a friendly looking priest had boarded the train immediately ahead of me. He had been out to the Mother-house near St. Francis Seminary and, as I learned later, was bringing a whole staff of teaching nuns to take charge of his school some place in Minnesota--about 20 of them it seemed to me. Besides this there were several other religious.